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United States Patent Application Publication	20250283329
Kind Code	A1
Publication Date	September 11, 2025
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Clamp Assembly for a Formwork System

Abstract

Various implementations described herein are directed to a formwork system. In one implementation, the formwork system includes aluminum extrusions and aluminum castings. The aluminum castings and the aluminum extrusions can be assembled by being pressed and riveted together.

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Appl. No.:	19/217276
Filed:	May 23, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 19073775 20250307 PENDING child US 19217276
parent US continuation 17988693 20221116 parent-grant-document US 12291864 child US 19073775
parent US continuation 16680368 20191111 parent-grant-document US 12116779 child US 17988693
parent US continuation 15630923 20170622 parent-grant-document US 10472823 child US 16680368
us-provisional-application US 62354325 20160624
us-provisional-application US 62471173 20170314

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: E04B2/86 (20060101); E04B2/14 (20060101); E04G9/02 (20060101); E04G11/00 (20060101); E04G11/06 (20060101); E04G11/08 (20060101); E04G11/54 (20060101); E04G11/56 (20060101); E04G13/02 (20060101); E04G17/00 (20060101); E04G17/04 (20060101); E04G17/06 (20060101); E04G17/065 (20060101); E04G17/14 (20060101); E04G17/16 (20060101); E04G21/32 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC E04B2/8629 (20130101); E04G11/00 (20130101); E04G11/062 (20130101); E04G11/085 (20130101); E04G11/087 (20130101); E04G11/54 (20130101); E04G11/56 (20130101); E04G13/02 (20130101); E04G17/00 (20130101); E04G17/001 (20130101); E04G17/002 (20130101); E04G17/042 (20130101); E04G17/0644 (20130101); E04G17/0652 (20130101); E04G17/14 (20130101); E04G17/16 (20130101); E04B2/14 (20130101); E04G2009/025 (20130101); E04G2009/028 (20130101); E04G2017/008 (20130101); E04G21/3276 (20130101)

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 19/073,775, filed on Mar. 7, 2025, published in English, which claims priority from U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/988,693 filed on Nov. 16, 2022, which is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/680,368, filed Nov. 11, 2019, now U.S. Pat. No. 12,116,779, issued on Oct. 15, 2024, which is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/630,923, filed Jun. 22, 2017, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,472,823, issued on Nov. 12, 2019, which claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Patent Application No. 62/471,173, filed Mar. 14, 2017 and 62/354,325, filed Jun. 24, 2016, the disclosures of which are herein incorporated by reference in their entireties.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0002] This section is intended to provide background information to facilitate a better understanding of various technologies described herein. As the section's title implies, this is a discussion of related art. That such art is related in no way implies that it is prior art. The related art may or may not be prior art. It should therefore be understood that the statements in this section are to be read in this light, and not as admissions of prior art.

[0003] Formwork systems have been used as a tool to help builders construct concrete structures. Many different pre-engineered modern formwork systems have been developed to mold liquid concrete into building systems. These systems have continued to develop in the last several decades to become more efficient, allowing contractors to help reduce overall construction costs, and to reduce schedule completion times.

[0004] There are many companies in existence today that have developed specific formwork systems and carry a sizable inventory, which can be both rented and sold to contractors who build concrete structures. The applications of formwork are unlimited given the wide range of project types in both the industrial and commercial construction markets. From high rise buildings to the construction of an industrial facility, formwork is used to help contractors cast foundations, columns, walls, and elevated slabs in an enormous variety of shapes and uses. Chances are that all of the places people live and work have some form of poured concrete that was cast using a formwork system. There is a substantial market for formwork in the construction industry worldwide.

[0005] Prior to the 1980's, older generation systems required providers to have a large inventory of

parts available to fit any configuration. They consisted of endless amounts of form panels, filler sizes, small bolts, pins, and other connecting hardware, that are used for assembly by a building contractor. The amount of inventoried items was high and the assembly efficiency for contractors was low. Because of the amount of pieces, it was common for many of these items to be lost during the construction process. Starting in the late 1980's, newer modular formwork system designs developed by international companies started hitting the worldwide market, and were subsequently introduced into the U.S.

[0006] These modular systems were being produced primarily out of Europe, required many less inventory items, eliminated small bolts and pins, and maintained a high degree of versatility. European systems began to migrate over to the Americas, and started to dominate the market, making the older systems in the U.S. virtually obsolete. Today, we see more and more of these systems hitting the ground in the U.S., but they were designed and built to service an international market, primarily outside the Americas. There is virtually no modern system in use today that is built for specific use in the U.S. These systems are generally manufactured in metric building units, which require additional components to convert to the U.S. Imperial unit of measure. In addition, they require a distinctly different inventory to build both straight and curved wall construction.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0007] Described herein are various implementations of a formwork system. In one implementation, the formwork system includes aluminum extrusions and aluminum castings. The aluminum castings and the aluminum extrusions can be assembled by being pressed and riveted together.

[0008] In one implementation, the aluminum extrusions can be side rail extrusions. In one implementation, the aluminum extrusions can be interior rail extrusions. The aluminum extrusions and the aluminum castings can be made of structural grade aluminum.

[0009] In one implementation, the aluminum extrusions and aluminum castings may be integrated into a shoring deck application.

[0010] Described herein are various implementations for a formwork system. In one implementation, the formwork system includes a first formwork panel having a first standard panel width. The formwork system also includes a second formwork panel having a second standard panel width different from the first panel width. The formwork system further includes an adjustable filler assembly.

[0011] In one implementation, the adjustable filler assembly includes two filler side rails and at least one adjustable inner rail. In another implementation, the adjustable filler assembly includes two filler side rails and radius cut lumber. In another implementation, the adjustable filler assembly includes two filler side rails and straight lumber.

[0012] Described herein are various implementations for an aluminum formwork system. The aluminum formwork system includes a clamp having: a first member having a first opening configured to accommodate a first flange; a second member having a second opening configured to accommodate a second flange; and a connector clip attached to the clamp and configured to be coupled to one or more attachments for the aluminum formwork system.

[0013] In one implementation, an accessory clip is attached to the connector clip. The accessory clip can be coupled to the one or more attachments.

[0014] The one or more attachments may include, but are not limited to, a pipe brace clip, an alignment bar, a lifting bar, and/or a tie-off point.

[0015] In one implementation, the first flange and the second flange are part of an inner rail. In another implementation, the first flange is part of a first side rail and the second flange is part of a second side rail. The first side rail and the second side rail may be connected by tightening the clamp.

[0016] The clamp can be a standard clamp that couples formwork panels and couples attachments to the formwork panels.

[0017] In one implementation, the formwork system includes a plurality of standard formwork panels. Each of the plurality of standard formwork panels has a respective height. The plurality of standard formwork panels has tie holes. The tie holes are configured to be symmetrical for all of the respective heights of the plurality of formwork panels.

[0018] In one implementation, the standard formwork panels are constructed of lightweight aluminum extrusions and fittings that are assembled with mechanical fasteners and have no welding.

[0019] In one implementation, various adjustable filler components are used to create on-demand filler panels sizes in a wide range of odd dimensional configurations, to meet dimensional requirements. This eliminates the need to carry an inventory of various pre-set sizes of filler panels and small shims.

[0020] In one implementation, a windmill overlap outside corner bracket is used to form outside corners of walls or columns.

[0021] In one implementation, standard form panels have the optional ability to increase the base design capacity by inserting a high pressure strut in critical locations where design pressures are higher than standard limits.

[0022] In one implementation, the formwork system includes aluminum extruded hinged corner extrusions having a first side and a second side. A first formwork panel is coupled to the first side of the hinged corner extrusion. A second formwork panel is coupled to the second side of the hinged corner extrusion. The hinged corner extrusion is configurable to position the first formwork panel and the second formwork panel at a plurality of angles. In one implementation, the aluminum extruded hinged corner extrusion comprises a hinged inside corner extrusion. In one implementation, the hinged corner extrusion comprises a hinged outside corner extrusion.

[0023] In one implementation, tie inserts are used with a formwork panel. Tie inserts may include self-sealing ties, tie plugs and tie inserts that install from the outside (or backside) of ganged form panel assemblies. This increases labor efficiency and reduces risk of concrete leakage through the tie port assembly.

[0024] In one implementation, Ringlok scaffolding is standardized as the access component of the formwork system. In one implementation, the same components also function as a moveable personal tie-off point accessory.

[0025] In one implementation, a dual purpose bracket can be used to both operate as a dry tie bracket and a hold down bracket. As a hold down bracket, the bracket is used to tie forms down to a base slab from vertical uplift loads. As a dry tie bracket, the bracket is used to place a dry tie over the top of the form.

[0026] In one implementation, standard clamps are used to connect one form panel to all adjacent panels, fillers or corners. The standard clamp also serves as the attachment point for all other accessories to the form panel, with the addition of the standard accessory clip vs. attaching accessories directly to the panels with various adaptor fixtures.

[0027] Described herein are various implementations of a method of assembling a formwork system. Aluminum extrusions are provided. Aluminum castings are provided. The aluminum castings and aluminum extrusions are pressed and riveted.

[0028] The aluminum extrusions can be side rail extrusions and/or interior rail extrusions. The aluminum extrusions and the aluminum castings can be made of structural grade aluminum.

[0029] In one implementation, the formwork system can be configured such that the aluminum extrusions and aluminum castings are integrated into a shoring deck application.

[0030] In one implementation, the aluminum extrusions are adjustable and a width of the aluminum extrusions can be incrementally adjusted using different configurations.

[0031] The aluminum extrusions can be assembled to be part of a series or system of formwork panels that are coupled together using a standard clamp. The formwork panels are constructed of lightweight aluminum extrusions and fittings and are assembled with mechanical fasteners and

have no welding. The standard clamp may also be used to couple attachments to the formwork panels. In one implementation, a connector clip can be attached to the standard clamp and configured to be coupled to one or more attachments for the formwork system. In one implementation, an accessory clip can be attached to the connector clip. The accessory clip can be coupled to the one or more attachments. The attachments may include, but are not limited to, a pipe brace clip, an alignment bar, a lifting bar, a tie-off point.

[0032] In one implementation, formwork panels can be coupled via an aluminum extruded hinged corner extrusion and configured to be positioned relative to each other at a plurality of angles.

[0033] In one implementation, the aluminum extruded hinged corner extrusion can be a hinged inside corner extrusion. In one implementation, the hinged corner extrusion can be a hinged outside corner extrusion.

[0034] In one implementation, tie inserts are used with a formwork panel. Tie inserts may include self-sealing ties, tie plugs and tie inserts that install from the outside (or backside) of ganged form panel assemblies. This increases labor efficiency and reduces risk of concrete leakage through the tie port assembly. A tie nut and rod assembly can be used to couple a formwork panel to an opposing formwork panel.

[0035] The above referenced summary section is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the detailed description section. Additional concepts and various other implementations are also described in the detailed description. The summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used to limit the scope of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to limit the number of inventions described herein. Furthermore, the claimed subject matter is not limited to implementations that solve any or all disadvantages noted in any part of this disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0036] Implementations of various techniques will hereafter be described with reference to the accompanying drawings. It should be understood, however, that the accompanying drawings illustrate only the various implementations described herein and are not meant to limit the scope of various techniques described herein.

[0037] FIGS. 1A-1T illustrate various formwork system component drawings in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0038] FIGS. 2A-2D illustrate a top view of wall and corner plan details of the present formwork system in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0039] FIGS. 3A-3C illustrate various wall plans in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0040] FIGS. 4A-4G illustrate side views of various wall configurations in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0041] FIGS. 5A-5D illustrate how a side rail, an interior rail and a tie extrusion fit together in the formwork system in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0042] FIGS. 6A-6G illustrate views of a side rail extrusion in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0043] FIG. 7 illustrates how a side rail, an interior rail and a tie extrusion fit together in the formwork system in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0044] FIGS. 8A-8D illustrate standard panel assembly plan views in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0045] FIGS. 9A-9B illustrate elevational views of a standard panel assembly in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0046] FIGS. **10A-10G** illustrate filler extensions and fittings in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0047] FIGS. **11A-11L** illustrate filler assembly plan views in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0048] FIGS. **12A-12O** illustrate the range of lengths achievable using adjustable fillers in the present formwork system in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0049] FIGS. **13A-13B** illustrate elevational views of the filler frame in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0050] FIGS. **14A-14F** illustrate corner assembly details in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0051] FIG. **15** illustrates a top cutaway view of the formwork system using a tic assembly in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0052] FIGS. **16A-16H** illustrate tie port inserts in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0053] FIGS. **17A-17B** illustrate a she bolt assembly in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0054] FIGS. **18A-18E** illustrate different views of a standard clamp in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0055] FIGS. **19A-19E** illustrate an accessory clip in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0056] FIGS. **20A-20D** illustrate various views of a scaffold bracket adaptor in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0057] FIGS. **21A-21D** illustrate various views of an alignment/lifting bar clamp attachment in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0058] FIGS. **22A-22E** illustrate additional alignment/lifting bar attachments in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0059] FIGS. **23A-23C** illustrate various views of a dry tic/hold down bracket in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0060] FIGS. **24A-24B** illustrate implementations of a dry tic/hold down bracket in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0061] FIGS. **25A-25W** illustrate various formwork system component drawings in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0062] FIGS. **26A-26E** show a top view of wall and corner plan details of the present formwork system in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0063] FIG. **27** shows a top view of a rectangular core wall configuration in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0064] FIGS. **28A-28C** show various wall plans that provide arc and circular configurations in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0065] FIGS. **29A-29G** show side views of various wall configurations in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0066] FIGS. **30A-30D** illustrate standard panel assembly plan views in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0067] FIGS. **31A-31E** illustrate elevational views of the standard panel assembly in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0068] FIGS. **32A-32G** illustrate views of a side rail extrusion, an interior rail extrusion, a corner casting and a tie extrusion in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0069] FIGS. **33A-33D** illustrate how a side rail, an interior rail and a tie extrusion fit together in the formwork system in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0070] FIGS. **34A-34U** illustrate filler assembly plan views in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0071] FIGS. **35A-35I** illustrate lumber and adjustable fillers in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0072] FIGS. **36A-36D** illustrate adjustable filler splice extrusions in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0073] FIGS. **37A-37F** illustrate lumber filler fittings and details in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0074] FIGS. **38A-38C** illustrate tie port inserts in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0075] FIG. **39** illustrates a top cross-sectional view of a tie rod assembly in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0076] FIG. **40** illustrates a top cross-sectional view of a she bolt and a tie rod assembly in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0077] FIG. **41** illustrates a top cutaway view of a tie rod and PVC sleeve in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0078] FIG. **42** illustrates a top cutaway view of a she bolt and tie rod assembly in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0079] FIGS. **43A-43D** illustrate various views of hinged inside corner and hinged outside corner extrusions in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0080] FIGS. **44A-44F** illustrate various connection configurations for inside corner extrusions and outside corner extrusions in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0081] FIGS. **45A-45D** illustrate a stripping inside corner in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0082] FIGS. **46A-46D** illustrate a stripping inside corner in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0083] FIGS. **47A-47C** illustrate an overlapping outside corner configuration in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0084] FIGS. **48A-48E** illustrate different views of a standard clamp in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0085] FIGS. **49A-49E** illustrate various views of an accessory clip in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0086] FIGS. **50A-50D** illustrate various views of a scaffold bracket adaptor in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0087] FIGS. **51A-51B** illustrate a Ringlok side bracket adaptor in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0088] FIGS. **52A-52D** illustrate various views of an alignment/lifting bar clamp attachment in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0089] FIGS. **53A-53E** illustrate additional alignment/lifting bar attachments in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0090] FIGS. **54A-54C** illustrate various views of a dry tic/hold down bracket in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0091] FIGS. **55A-55B** illustrate implementations of a dry tic application and a hold down bracket application in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

[0092] FIG. **56** illustrate a block diagram of a method of assembling a formwork system in accordance with implementations of various techniques described herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0093] The formwork system of the present disclosure has been designed to rectify many of the short comings of imported European formwork systems, provides a further reduction in the amount

of components needed, and provides a high degree of versatility. In one implementation, the formwork system may be built from non-welded lightweight aluminum components. The present formwork system may also have implementations that include a synthetic form face. Most prior art systems are made from welded rolled steel, and use a wood form face that has to be replaced periodically. The unique design and manufacture of the new formwork system of the present disclosure vastly elevates the inventory service life, improves aspects of inventory maintenance, and offers a significant reduction in the amount of different components needed to achieve an enormous variety of usable configurations. Various unique features of the present formwork system are described in more detail below.

[0094] The present formwork system design includes several key unique features that are not found in similar systems currently available in the market. The improvement provided by this new formwork system, which may be composed of non-welded aluminum components, is that this formwork system has significantly less components in its usable inventory, as compared to prior art formwork systems. The present formwork system also has a unique approach to the type of materials used in its construction, as well as the method of assembly and manufacture. The present formwork system may also be configured to be used in shoring deck applications. The combination of minimizing required components and the unique method of manufacture is what separates the present formwork system from prior art formwork systems currently being offered to the construction industry.

[0095] The present formwork system reduces the amount of inventoried components by over 75%, as compared to existing systems. The main driver to eliminate many infrequently used items is the use of the fabricated Filler Side Rail in various applications. In combination with the robust nature of the materials of the present formwork system and the method of assembly, the cost to own the present formwork system can vastly be reduced for both a dead asset basis, as well as the physical maintenance cost required to maintain a formwork inventory. In addition, the present formwork system elevates the flexibility to handle field applications, as well as increase the efficiency for the contractors that will use the present formwork system to build concrete structures.

[0096] FIGS. **1A-1T** include various formwork system component drawings. FIGS. **1A-1T** include plan views of the formwork at various widths (adjustable **110**, lumber **112**, standard 2' panel **108**, standard 3' panel **106**). FIGS. **1A-1T** also include views of clamps, brackets, clips, adapters, supports, assemblies and braces used with the formwork system. Additionally, FIGS. **1A-1T** show an implementation that couples the present formwork system with a standard scaffold.

[0097] FIG. **1A-1B** include corner brackets **102**, **104**, **114**. Element **102** is an inside hinged corner. Element **104** is a hinged stripping corner and element **114** is a hinged outside corner bracket. The hinged and stripping corner brackets may be aluminum components.

[0098] As illustrated in FIG. **1I**, which depicts a standard clamp **128a** and a side **128b** of the standard clamp, is the primary method of attaching all accessories to the standard form panels. Standard clamp **128a** may also be used to tie formwork panels having different heights and as a lifting device for a series of ganged formwork panels.

[0099] As illustrated in FIG. **1K**, element **126** is a standard pipe brace with a clip assembly. Pipe brace **126** can be used to provide support for scaffolding.

[0100] As illustrated in FIG. **1P**, standard pin lock scaffolding adaptor is shown at element **124**. Scaffold bracket adaptor **118** is used in this configuration.

[0101] As illustrated in FIG. **1H**, accessory clip **116** attaches to the standard clamp and serves as a standard connection for the alignment bar configuration (using alignment bar **122**), pipe brace attachment (using pipe brace **126**), and lifting bar configuration (using gang lifting configuration **123** and lifting bracket **120**).

[0102] A dry tie or hold down bracket **130** and an alignment center support **132** are included in FIG. **1R**, which also illustrates a side **132b** of alignment center support **132a**. Also included in FIG. **15** is the tie nut and rod assembly **136**.

[0103] An outside corner bracket configuration **134** is also shown in FIG. **1K**. This outside corner bracket **133** is used to attach to formwork panels, e.g., formwork panels **106**, **108** in a corner configuration.

[0104] FIGS. **2A-2D** show a top view of wall and corner plan details of the present formwork system. Also shown is an alignment bar **122** configuration that can be used to provide additional support for the panels. Item **205** shows a wall detail at an inside corner using standard panels **106**, **108** and adjustable filler **110**. In addition, tie rod assemblies **207**, standard clamps (not shown) and corner brackets **102**, **114** are included. Item **210** shows wall details for an implementation of a variable angle inside corner using corner bracket **102**. The implementation of item **210** uses lumber filler **112** and formwork panel **106**; however, other implementations may include adjustable filler, lumber filler and/or other standard panels. Item **215** shows details for a windmill column using standard panels, e.g., formwork panel **108**, and a hinged outside corner bracket **133**.

[0105] FIGS. **3A-3C** show various wall plans that provide arc and circular configurations. Item **305** is illustrated in FIG. **3A** as an implementation that provides a large diameter tank or serpentine walls **307** provided using lumber inner rails (not shown), lumber clips **309**, filler side rails **112**, tie rod assemblies **207** and standard clamps (not shown). Item **310** is shown in FIG. **3B** as standard panels with an arc shaped or rounded nose that is provided using standard panels **108**, filler side rails (not shown), lumber inner rails **312**, lumber clips **314** and tie rod assemblies **207**, and standard clamps (not shown). Item **315** is shown in FIG. **3B** as a circular column provided using filler side rails (not shown), lumber inner rails **312**, lumber clips **314** and standard clamps (not shown).

[0106] FIGS. **4A-4G** show side views of various wall configurations. As stated previously, standard panels can be 2' or 3' in width. Each standard panel **106**, **108** of width 2' or 3' can have a panel length of 3', 6', or 9' as shown in panels **426**, **424**, and **422**, respectively. Item **405** is shown in FIG. **4A** and illustrates 3' panels **426** supported by a tie assembly **207** or dry tie (as described below) on a top portion and a hold down assembly **407** or tie assembly on a bottom portion. Hold down assemblies and dry tie assemblies are described in further detail in FIGS. **24A-24B** and FIG. **55A-55B**. Item **410** is shown in FIG. **4B** and illustrates 9' panels **422** supported by three tie assemblies **207** or dry ties. Item **410** also shows a standard scaffold **124** attached to a 9' panel **422** using a scaffold bracket adaptor **412** and secured with a pipe brace assembly **126**. Item **415** is shown in FIG. **4C** and illustrates a vertical panel shear condition where panels **422**, **424**, **426** having different lengths, e.g., 3', 6' and 9', are used. This type of configuration, i.e., using unequal heights for the formwork, is made possible because the formwork uses standardized tie hole locations for tie assemblies **207**. Item **415** also includes the scaffolding **124** described in item **410**. Item **420** is illustrated in FIG. **4D** and shows typical panel heights (9' (panel **422**), 6' (panel **424**) and 4' (panel **426**)) for the formwork system. In addition, a gang lifting configuration is shown. The gang lifting configuration **123** is used to move one or more panels, for example, with a crane or some other lifting/moving apparatus.

[0107] FIG. **5A** illustrates how a side rail **532**, an interior rail **536** and a tie extrusion **604** fit together in the formwork system. In particular, the views of FIG. **5A** show back side views of the formwork system. Item **505** shows a top cutaway view of the formwork system. View **505** shows side rail **532**, form face **534** and tie extrusion **604**. Item **510** shows a side view of the formwork system. In this view, side rail **532**, interior rail **536** and the tie extrusion **604** are clearly shown. Different types of tie port inserts **520**, **525**, **530**, which are illustrated in FIGS. **5B**, **5C** and **5D**, respectively, may be used within tie extrusion **604**. These tie port inserts are discussed further in FIGS. **16A-16H**. Item **515** shows a vertical cutaway view of a portion of the formwork system. This view shows the interior rail **536** in further detail along with tie extrusion **604** and side rail **532**.

[0108] FIGS. **6A-6G** illustrate views of a side rail extrusion **532**, an interior rail extrusion **536**, a corner casting **602** and a tie extrusion **604**. Items **620**, **625**, **630** show various views of tie extrusion **604**. Item **615** is illustrated in FIG. **6C** and shows a top view of corner casting **602**. Item **617** is illustrated in FIG. **6D** and shows an elevational side view of corner casting **602**. Corner casting **602**

includes arms **632, 634, 636, 638**. The inside rail extrusions **536** can be press fit with the side rail extrusions **532** and/or with arms **632, 634, 636, 638** of the corner casting **602** to together make up part of the assembly for the formwork panels. It should be noted that when two side rails **532** are placed back to back, they form the same basic shape as the inner rail **536**. Having the same basic shape makes the connection of a standard clamp identical in both the vertical and horizontal positions. The standard clamp is described further in FIG. **18**. The flange design on the inner & side rails help to increase the pull away capacity of the standard clamp, which is useful since the standard clamp is used to attach all of the accessories. The use of the standard clamp to attach all of the accessories is unique to this formwork system.

[0109] FIG. **7** illustrates how a side rail **532**, an interior rail **536** and a tie extrusion **604** fit together in the formwork system. In particular, the views of FIG. **7** show the items of FIG. **5** from a face side of the formwork system.

[0110] FIGS. **8A-8D** illustrate standard panel assembly plan views. Top/bottom **805, 810** and cutaway elements **815, 820** are shown for both 3 ft (panel **106**) and 2 ft (panel **108**) panel widths. In addition, elements **815, 820** show side rail **532** and form face **534**.

[0111] FIGS. **9A-9B** illustrate elevational views of a standard panel assembly, e.g., panel **424**. Item **905** shows an elevational view. Item **905** is shown in FIG. **9A** and includes side rail **532**, inner rail **536**, and tie extrusion **604**. Item **910** is shown in FIG. **9B** and shows a side elevational view.

[0112] FIGS. **10A-10G** illustrate filler extensions and fittings. In particular, FIG. **10A** shows a left hand view **1005**, FIG. **10B** shows an edge view **1010** and FIG. **10C** shows a right hand view **1015** of a filler edge clip **1002** are shown. Also shown in FIGS. **10D** and **10E** is a lumber inner rail clip **1020, 1025** an adjustable filler splice extrusion **1030** in FIG. **10F** and an optional steel splice **1035** in FIG. **10G**.

[0113] FIGS. **11A-11L** illustrate filler assembly plan views. FIGS. **11A-11L** show plan views of different configurations for adjustable fillers **1105** and lumber filler **1110** including any necessary extrusions and clips. Configurations for adjustable fillers may include combinations of adjustable filler assembly components **1114, 1116, 1118, 1120, 1122**. Using these adjustable fillers provides greater flexibility and reduces the need for lumber filler in the formwork system. Using the adjustable filler assembly components provides the ability to incrementally adjust the filler from 18 inches to 31 inches. In one implementation, the adjustable filler can be incrementally adjusted in half-inch increments. In one implementation, the adjustable filler assembly includes spring loaded pins to attach the assembly components. The adjustable filler can be made from aluminum or galvanized steel. Lumber filler of varying sizes can still be used when necessary, however, through the use of the adjustable filler, the need for lumber filler is greatly reduced in the present formwork system. Configurations **1110** for lumber filler may include clips **1130, 1132, 1134** and adjustable filler components **1114, 1118** for curved **1124** and straight **1126, 1128** lumber inner rails.

[0114] FIGS. **12A-12O** illustrate various configurations **1205** for the range of lengths **1207, 1209, 1211, 1213, 1215, 1217, 1219, 1221, 1223, 1225, 1227, 1229, 1231, 1233, 1235** achievable using adjustable fillers in the present formwork system. In the present implementation, the length can be adjusted from 18 inches to 25 inches.

[0115] FIGS. **13A-13B** illustrate elevational views of the filler frame. Item **1305** shows a back view of a variable filler elevation. Item **1305** is illustrated in FIG. **13A** and shows a panel that includes inner rails **1307**, side rails **532** and tie extrusion **604**. Item **1310** is illustrated in FIG. **13B** and shows a side view of a variable filler elevation.

[0116] FIGS. **14A-14F** illustrate corner assembly details. Plan views for a hinged inside corner **102, 1405** and a hinged outside corner **114, 1410** are shown. Hinged inside corner includes arms **1407, 1408** and cross bar **1409**. Also shown are partial elevation views of the hinged outside corner **1415** and the hinged inside corner **1420**. Further, connection details **1425, 1430** illustrating how the hinged corners are connected to the panels **106, 108** using the standard clamp **128a** are shown for the inside corner hinge and the outside corner hinge.

[0117] FIG. **15** illustrates a top cutaway view of the formwork system using a tie assembly, e.g., tie assembly **207**. The tie assembly includes a tie rod **1510** and a wing nut **1505**. The tie rod passes through a tie port insert **1515** and a polyvinyl chloride (PVC) sleeve **1520** and is used to tie one panel to another using a second wing nut (not shown).

[0118] FIGS. **16A-16H** illustrate tie port inserts for insertion into tie extrusion **604**. Tie port inserts can be permanent inserts **1605**, plugs **1610**, flush tie inserts **1615** and cone tie inserts **1620**. The flush tie inserts and cone tie inserts may include a PVC sleeve, e.g., sleeve **1510**.

[0119] FIGS. **17A-17B** illustrate a she bolt assembly **1705**. She bolt assembly includes wing nut **1707**, rod **1709** and rod **1711**. The she bolt assembly is used to secure one formwork assembly to another. This she bolt assembly may secure the form panels to each other using tie port inserts in the form panels.

[0120] FIGS. **18A-18E** illustrate different views of a standard clamp **128a**. In item **1805**, the clamp **128a** is shown clamping two side rails **532**. In item **1810**, the clamp **128a** is shown clamping an inner rail **536**. The standard clamp is designed to tighten with a screw mechanism and generally can be tightened without using a tool. Using this type of standard clamp makes all accessory connections more efficient and easier for the end user. The screw mechanism is safer than other coupling mechanisms because the clamp will not loosen as easily if someone accidentally hits the clamp. The accessory clip **1820** that attaches to the standard clamp serves as a standard connection for the alignment bar configuration, personal tie-off point, pipe brace attachment, and lifting bar configuration. FIGS. **18A-18E** correspond to FIGS. **48A-48E** which are described in more detail below.

[0121] FIGS. **19A-19E** illustrate an accessory clip **1905**. The accessory clip **1905** can be used with the standard clamp and for various other applications, e.g., pipe brace clip, alignment bar, lifting bar and tie-off point. FIGS. **19A-19E** show a top view **1907** and side views **1909**, **1913** of accessory clip **1905**. Sleeve **1911** of accessory clip **1905** is also shown. Accessory clip **1905** may be attached to standard clamp **128a** using screw assembly **1915**. FIGS. **19A-19E** correspond to FIG. **49A-49E**, which are described in more detail below.

[0122] FIGS. **20A-20D** illustrate various views **2005** of a scaffold bracket adaptor **118**. The scaffold bracket adaptor **118** may be attached to the standard clamp **128a** using nut **2009**. FIGS. **20A-20D** correspond to FIGS. **50A-50D**, which are described in more detail below.

[0123] FIGS. **21A-21D** illustrate various views of an alignment/lifting bar clamp attachment **2105**. The alignment/lifting bar clamp **2105** can be coupled to standard accessory clip **2107**. The alignment/lifting bar clamp **2107** and standard accessory clip **2107** can be coupled to standard clamp **128a** using screw assembly **2111**. FIGS. **21A-21D** correspond to FIGS. **52A-52D**, which are described in more detail below.

[0124] FIGS. **22A-22E** illustrate additional alignment/lifting bar attachments. FIGS. **22A-22C**, respectively, include various views **2205**, **2207**, **2209** of an optional center support attachment **132a** and FIGS. **22D** and **22E**, respectively, include various views **2210**, **2212** of a lifting bracket attachment **120a** and a side **120b** of lifting bracket attachment **120a**.

[0125] FIGS. **23A-23C**, respectively, illustrate various views **2305**, **2310**, **2315** of a dry tie/hold down bracket **130**. FIGS. **24A-24B** illustrate implementations of a dry tie/hold down bracket **130**. Item **2405**, illustrated in FIG. **24A**, is a view of a dry tie application and item **2410**, illustrated in FIG. **24B**, is a view of a hold down application. Also shown in FIG. **23A** is tie assembly **207** and form face **534**. FIGS. **23A-23C** and **24A-24B** correspond to FIGS. **54A-54C** and **55A-55B**, which are described in more detail below.

[0126] FIGS. **25A-25W** include plan views of the formwork at various widths (adjustable **2540**, lumber (straight **2542** and radius **2544**), standard 2' panel **2538**, standard 3' panel **2536**). FIGS. **25A-25W** also include views of clamps, brackets, clips, adaptors, supports, assemblies, insert systems and braces used with the formwork system. Additionally, FIGS. **25A-25W** show an implementation that couples the present formwork system with a standard scaffold.

[0127] FIGS. 25A-25W include corner brackets **2502**, **2504**, **2506**. Element **2502** is an inside stripping corner bracket. Element **2504** is a hinged inside corner bracket and element **2506** is a hinged outside corner bracket. The hinged inside and outside corner brackets **2504**, **2506** may be aluminum components. Brackets **2504**, **2506** can be configured to be set at a 90 degree angle. In some implementations, brackets **2504**, **2506** can be configured to be set at angles other than 90 degrees.

[0128] Standard clamp **2508** is the primary method of attaching all accessories to the standard form panels. Standard clamp **2508** may also be used to tie formwork panels having different heights and as a lifting device for a series of ganged formwork panels. Also illustrated (in FIG. 25D) is a side view **2508b** of the standard clamps **2508a**.

[0129] Element **2510** is a standard LD and HD pipe brace with a clip assembly. Element **2512** is a turnbuckle brace with a clip assembly. Pipe brace **2510** can be used to provide support for scaffolding. Turnbuckle brace **2512** can be used to provide support for a formwork panel.

[0130] The accessory clip **2514** attaches to the standard clamp and serves as a standard connection for the alignment bar configuration (using alignment bar **2520**), personal tie-off point (using Ringlok adaptor **2516**), pipe brace attachment (using pipe brace **2510**), and lifting bar configuration (using gang lifting configuration **2522**). Also illustrated (in FIG. 25E) is a side view **2514b** of the accessory clip **2514a**.

[0131] When used as a personal tie-off point, Ringlok adaptor **2516** can be attached to inner rails of the formwork panels. Scaffold assembly **2524** includes a pin-lock scaffold bracket and post **2523** and includes a Ringlok adaptor **2516**, Ringlok leg material **2517** and two standard clamps **2508** coupled to the pin-lock scaffold bracket and post **2523**. Also illustrated (in FIG. 25E) is a side view **2516b** of the Ringlok adaptor **2516a**.

[0132] Standard adjustable shear wall bracket **2526** is used to support the weight of the form panels and fillers in a shear wall or exterior wall condition.

[0133] A dry tie or hold down bracket **2528** is included in FIG. 25K. This element is further described below with respect to FIGS. 54A-54C and FIGS. 55A-55B.

[0134] A self-sealing tie and color-coded insert system **2530** is included in FIGS. 25A-25W. The various elements of the self-sealing tie and color-coded insert system **2530** are further described below with respect to FIGS. 33A-34U and 36A-42.

[0135] An outside corner bracket configuration **2534** is also shown in FIG. 25A-25W. This outside corner bracket **2546** is used to attach to formwork panels **2536**, **2538** in a corner configuration. The outside corner bracket can be adjusted in 1" increments along one of the formwork panels in the corner configuration. The outside corner bracket can be adjusted up to 1', e.g., 3" to 15", when a 2' panel is used and up to 2', e.g., 15" to 27", when a 3' panel is used.

[0136] FIGS. 26A-26E show a top view of wall and corner plan details of the present formwork system. Also shown is an alignment bar configuration **2520** that can be used to provide additional support for the panels. Element **2605**, illustrated in FIG. 26A, shows a wall detail at an inside corner using standard panels **2536**, **2538** and adjustable filler **2540**. In addition, tie rod assemblies **2607**, standard clamps (not shown), inside corner brackets **2504** and aluminum outside corner brackets **2506** are shown. Element **2610**, illustrated in FIG. 26B, shows wall details for an implementation of a variable angle inside corner. The implementation of element **2610** uses lumber filler **2542** in addition to standard panel **2538**; however, other implementations may include adjustable filler, lumber filler and/or standard panels. Element **2615**, illustrated in FIG. 26C, shows details for a column **2617** using standard panels **2536** and outside windmill corner brackets **2546**.

[0137] FIG. 27 shows a top view of a rectangular core wall configuration **2705**. This particular configuration **2705** is achieved using standard panels **2536**, adjustable fillers **2540**, tie rod assemblies **2607**, inside stripping corners **2502** and outside hinged corners **2506**.

[0138] FIGS. 28A-28C show various wall plans that provide arc and circular configurations. Element **2805**, shown in FIG. 28A, illustrates an implementation that provides a large diameter

tank or serpentine walls **2807** provided using lumber filler forms **2544**, tie rod assemblies **2607** and standard clamps (not shown). Element **2810**, illustrated in FIG. **28B**, shows standard panels **2536** with an arc shaped or rounded nose **2814** that is provided using standard panels **2536** and tie rod assemblies **2607**, a lumber filler form **2814**, lumber clips **2812** and standard clamps (not shown). Element **2815**, illustrated in FIG. **28C**, shows a circular column **2817** provided using lumber filler forms **2814**, lumber clips **2812** and standard clamps (not shown).

[0139] FIGS. **29A-29F** show side views of various wall configurations. As stated previously, standard panels can be 2' or 3' in width. Each standard panel **2536**, **2538** of width 2' or 3' can have a panel length of 3', 6', or 9' as shown in panels **2926**, **2924**, **2922**, respectively. Element **2905**, shown in FIG. **29A**, illustrates short panel walls **2926**, e.g., 3' or 4', supported by a dry tie **2907** on a top portion and a hold down or tie assembly **2909** on a bottom portion. Additionally, in element **2905**, bracing **2512** is shown. Element **2910**, shown in FIG. **29B**, illustrates tall panel walls **2922** supported by three tie assemblies **2607** or dry ties. Element **2910** also shows a standard scaffold **2524** attached to the tall panel walls **2922** using a scaffold bracket adaptor **2517** and secured with a pipe brace assembly **2510**. Element **2915**, shown in FIG. **29C**, illustrates a vertical panel shear condition where panels **2922**, **2924**, **2926** having different lengths, e.g., 3', 6' and 9', are used. This type of configuration, i.e., using unequal heights for the formwork, is made possible because the formwork uses standardized tie hole locations. Element **2915** also includes the scaffolding described in element **2910**. Element **2920**, illustrated in FIG. **29D**, shows typical panel heights (9' (panel **2922**), 6' (panel **2924**) and 4' (panel **2926**)) for the formwork system. In addition, a gang lifting configuration **2522** is shown. The gang lifting configuration **2522** is used to move one or more panels, for example, with a crane or some other lifting/moving apparatus.

[0140] FIG. **30A-30D** illustrate standard panel assembly plan views. Top/bottom **3010**, **3020** and cutaway views **3005**, **3015** are shown for both 3 ft (panel **2536**) and 2 ft (panel **2538**) panel widths.

[0141] FIG. **31A-31E** illustrate elevational views **3110**, **3120** of the standard panel assembly for 2' (panel **2538**) and 3' (panel **2536**) widths. FIGS. **31D**, **31E** and **31C**, respectively, illustrate top/bottom **3105**, **3115** and side elevational **3125** views of panels **2536**, **2538** are also shown. Standard panels **2536**, **2538** include side rails **532**, inner rails **536** and tie extrusion **3225**.

[0142] FIGS. **32A-32G** illustrate views of a side rail extrusion **532**, an interior rail extrusion **536**, a p **3242** and a tie extrusion **3225**. Item **3215**, illustrated in FIG. **32C**, shows a top view of corner casting **3242**. Item **3220**, illustrated in FIG. **32D**, shows an elevational side view of corner casting **3242**. Corner casting includes arms **3244**, **3246**, **3248**, **3250**. The inside rail extrusions (interior rail extrusions **536**) can be coupled to side rail extrusions **532** and/or press fit with arms **3244**, **3246**, **3248**, **3250** of corner castings **3225** to together make up part of the assembly for the formwork panels. It should be noted that when two side rails **532** are placed (as shown) back to back, they form the same basic shape as the inner rail **536**. Having the same basic shape makes the connection of a standard clamp identical in both the vertical and horizontal positions. The standard clamp is described further in Figure **48A-48E**. The flange design **3207**, **3209** on the inner & side rails **532**, **536** help to increase the pull away capacity of the standard clamp **2508a**, which is useful since the standard clamp **2508a** is used to attach all of the accessories. The use of the standard clamp **2508a** to attach all of the accessories is unique to this formwork system.

[0143] Different views of the tie extrusion **3225** are shown in FIG. **32E-32G**. Tie extrusion **3225** has an opening **3227** for a tie rod. Openings **3232**, **3234** of tie extrusion **3225** are used to attach the tie extrusion **3225** to the interior rail extrusion **536**. Openings **3236**, **3237**, **3238**, **3239** are used to attach the tie extrusion to the side rail extrusion.

[0144] FIG. **33A-33D** illustrates how a side rail **532**, an interior rail **536** and a tie extrusion **3225** fit together in the formwork system. In particular, the views of FIG. **33A-33D** show back side views of the formwork system. Element **3305**, illustrated in FIG. **33A**, shows a top cutaway view of the formwork system. Element **3310** shows a side view of the formwork system. In this view, side rail **532**, interior rail **536** and the tie extrusion **3225** are clearly shown. Different types of tie port inserts

3311, 3312, 3313 may be used within tie extrusion **3225**. These tie port inserts are discussed further in FIG. **38**. Element **3315** shows a vertical cutaway view of a portion of the formwork system. This view shows the interior rail **536** in further detail along with tie extrusion **3225** and side rail **532**. [0145] FIGS. **34A-34U** illustrates filler assembly plan views. FIGS. **34A-34U** show plan views of different configurations for adjustable fillers and lumber filler including any necessary extrusions, clips, inside splices and outside splices. Configurations for adjustable fillers may include combinations of adjustable filler assembly components **3406, 3410, 3414, 3418, 3422a**. Using these adjustable fillers provides greater flexibility and reduces the need for field fitted lumber shimming in the formwork system. Using the adjustable filler assembly components provides the ability to incrementally adjust the filler. Tie locations can be placed in panels having adjustable or lumber fillers. Straight or curved lumber fillers of varying sizes can still be used when necessary, however, through the use of the adjustable filler, the need for lumber filler is greatly reduced in the present formwork system. Configurations for lumber filler may include filler side rails **3422** and clips **3424a, 3424b, 3425, 3426a** for curved **3402** and straight **3404** lumber inner rails. [0146] Filler side rails **3422 a** can be used in both lumber and adjustable filler configurations. An opposing end **3422b** of filler side rail **3422a** is illustrated in FIG. **34K**. Filler side rails can be 4', 6', or 9' in height. Filler side rails can be attached to inside splices **3406, 3414**. Inside splices **3406, 3414** can be 5½ inches or 8½ inches long. FIGS. **34D** and **34E** illustrate elements **3408** and **3416**, which are side views of inside splices **3406** and **3414**, respectively. Filler side rails can also be attached to lumber inner rail clip **3426a**. FIG. **34M** illustrates element **3426b**, which is a side view of lumber inner rail clip **3426a**. Left and right edge clips **3424a, 3424b** are used to attach to adjacent filler side rails at top and bottom. Further details regarding the edge clips **3424a, 3424b** are described below in FIG. **37A-37F**. Outside splices **3410, 3418** can be attached to inside splices **3406, 3414**. Outside splices can be 6½ or 10½ inches long. FIGS. **34F** and **34J** illustrates elements **3412** and **3420**, which are side views of outside splices **3410** and **3418**, respectively. The “U” connector **3430** is used to connect various components. In one implementation, the “U” connector is used to attach the splices together and to attach the adjustable or lumber rail to the filler side rail. Further details regarding “U” connector connections are described below in FIGS. **36A-36D** and **37A-37F**.

[0147] FIG. **34A** illustrates element **3402**, which is a configuration having filler side rails **3422a** with lumber clips **3426a** and radius cut lumber **3448**. FIG. **34B** illustrates element **3404**, which is a configuration having filler side rails **3422a** with lumber clips **3426a** and sized or straight lumber **3450**.

[0148] FIG. **34O** illustrates element **3432**, which is a configuration having two 10½ inch outside splices and three 8½ inch inside splices. This configuration is adjustable from 29 to 43 inches in one inch increments.

[0149] FIG. **34P** illustrates element **3434**, which is a configuration having one 8½ inch inside splice, two 5½ inch inside splices and one 10½ inch outside splice. This configuration is adjustable from 29 to 37 inches in one inch increments.

[0150] FIG. **34Q** illustrates element **3436**, which is a configuration having two 8½ inch inside splices and one 10½ inch outside splice. This configuration is adjustable from 20 to 28 inches in one inch increments.

[0151] FIG. **34R** illustrates element **3438**, which is a configuration having two 5½ inch inside splices and one 6½ inch outside splice. This configuration is adjustable from 14 to 18 inches in one inch increments.

[0152] FIG. **34S** illustrates element **3440**, which is a configuration having two 5½ inch inside splices and one 10½ inch outside splice. This configuration is adjustable from 18 to 22 inches in one inch increments.

[0153] FIG. **34T** illustrates element **3442**, which is a configuration that includes a single 5½ inch inside splice. This configuration is adjustable from 8 to 10 inches in 1 inch increments.

[0154] FIG. **34U** illustrates element **3444**, which is a configuration that includes a single 8½ inch inside splice. This configuration is adjustable from 11 to 13 inches in one inch increments. [0155] FIGS. **35A-35I** illustrate lumber and adjustable fillers. Top/bottom views of adjustable filler **3432** and adjustable filler **3436** are shown. Adjustable fillers **3432** and **3436** have different adjustable filler widths. A top/bottom view of lumber filler **3404** is shown. Also shown are top/bottom **3535** and elevational side **3545** and end **3540** views of an edge clip **3424**. Elevational views of interior rail configurations of variable/adjustable fillers **3510**, **3520** and lumber filler **3530** are also shown.

[0156] FIGS. **36A-36D** illustrate adjustable filler splice extrusions. FIGS. **36A-36D** also show how the adjustable filler splice extrusions **3602**, **3607** are connected, e.g., using “U” connector **3620**. Front **3605**, side **3610** and top **3615** elevational views show how the adjustable fillers **3602**, **3607** are connected to the side rail extrusion **532** and the tie extrusion **3225** using the “U” connectors **3620**. The synthetic nailer **3609** is used to fasten the form face **534** material (plywood or synthetic) to the body of the assembled adjustable or lumber filler frame

[0157] The side rail **532**, interior rails **536**, corner castings **3242**, and tie extrusion **3225** are made of structural grade aluminum. In one implementation, the structural grade aluminum can be 6060-T6 or equivalent.

[0158] FIGS. **37A-37F** illustrate filler side rail edge fittings and lumber inner rail fittings and details. In particular, a left hand view **3705**, illustrated in FIG. **37A**, an edge view **3710**, illustrated in FIG. **37B**, and a right hand **3715** view, illustrated in FIG. **37C**, of a filler edge clip **3702** are shown. Also shown are different views **3720** illustrated in FIG. **37E**, for coupling a lumber clip **3426** to a side rail **532** and a tie extrusion **3225** and further attaching the lumber clip to a lumber inner rail **3625**, for example, using a “U” connector **3620**.

[0159] FIGS. **38A-38C** illustrate tie port inserts. Tie port inserts can be permanent inserts **3820**, plugs **3825**, she-bolt tie washers **3830** and cone tie inserts **3835**. FIG. **38B-38C** show different top cross-sectional configurations for tie port inserts. These views show the tie port inserts projecting through the form frame **3815** and the form facing panel **3810**. These views also show poured concrete **3805** adjacent to the form facing panel. A permanent insert **3820** is press-fit into the form frame **3815** and an end of the permanent insert occupies an opening of the form facing panel **3810**. Plug insert **3825** fits within permanent insert **3820** and is used to prevent concrete from leaking through the tie ports. She-bolt tie washer **3830** can be used to secure a tie rod passing through a sleeve **3840** passing through permanent insert **3820** and protruding out from form facing panel **3810** into the area for the concrete **3805**. Cone tie insert **3835** can be used to pass a tie rod through concrete while keeping the concrete from hardening on a surface of the tie rod. The cone tie insert **3835** is passed through permanent insert **3820** and protrudes out from the form facing panel. A sleeve **3845**, e.g., a PVC sleeve, can be attached to the cone tie insert to prevent concrete from coming into contact with the tie rod.

[0160] FIG. **39** illustrates a top cross-sectional view of a tie rod assembly **2607** at panel **3902**. A form face **534** of panel **3902** and a side rail **532** are also shown. The tie assembly includes a tie rod **3905** and a wing nut **3910**. The tie rod passes through a permanent insert **3915** and a cone tie insert **3920** inserted into the permanent insert **3915**. The tie rod further passes through a PVC sleeve **3925** attached to the tie rod insert. The tie rod is used to tie one panel to an opposing panel. Also shown at panel **3904**, which is serially attached to panel **3902**, is a plug insert **3935** inserted into permanent insert **3930**.

[0161] FIG. **40** illustrates a top cross-sectional view of a she bolt and a tie rod assembly **2607** at panel **4002**. A form face **534** of panel **4002** and a side rail **532** are also shown. The tie rod assembly includes a tie rod **4005**, she-bolt **4020** and a wing nut **4010**. The tie rod and she-bolt pass through a permanent insert **4015**. The tie rod is secured to the panel using she bolt **4020** and wing nut **4010**. The tie rod is used to tie one panel to an opposing panel. Also shown at panel **4004**, which is serially attached to panel **4002**, is a plug insert **4035** inserted into permanent insert **4030**.

[0162] FIG. **41** illustrates a top cutaway view of a tie rod and PVC sleeve at adjustable filler panel **4102** (e.g., components **3432**, **3436**). On one side of the adjustable filler panel **4102**, the tie assembly **2607** includes a tie rod **4105** and a wing nut **4110**. The tie rod **4105** passes through a permanent insert **4115** and a cone tie insert **4120** inserted into the permanent insert **4115**. The tie rod further passes through a PVC sleeve **4125** attached to the cone tie insert **4120**. The tie rod is used to tie one panel to an opposing panel.

[0163] On another side of adjustable filler panel **4102**, illustrates an optional tie assembly showing the tie rod **4140** passes through a permanent insert **4150** and a she-bolt **4145** inserted into the permanent insert **4150**. The tie rod **4140** is secured to the panel using she bolt **4145** and a wing nut, not shown. The tie rod is used to tie one panel to an opposing panel. Also shown at panel **4104**, which is serially attached to panel **4102**, is a plug insert **4135** inserted into permanent insert **4130**.

[0164] FIG. **42** illustrates a top cutaway view of a she bolt and tie rod assembly at adjustable filler panel **4102** (e.g., components **3432**, **3436**). On one side of the adjustable filler panel **4202**, the tie rod **4140** and she-bolt **4245** passes through a permanent insert **4250**. The tie rod **4240** is secured to the panel using she bolt **4245** and wing nut **4210**. The tie rod **4240** is used to tie one panel to an opposing panel.

[0165] On another side of adjustable filler panel **4202**, the optional tie assembly includes a tie rod **4205** and a wing nut (not shown). The tie rod **4205** passes through a permanent insert **4215** and a cone tie insert **4220** inserted into the permanent insert **4215**. The tie rod **4205** further passes through a PVC sleeve **4225** attached to the cone tie insert **4220**. The optional tie rod is used to tie one panel to an opposing panel. Also shown at panel **4204**, which is serially attached to panel **4202**, is a plug insert **4235** inserted into permanent insert **4230**.

[0166] Once formwork is set, tie inserts and the tie rod are assembled and slide into position from a back side of the panel. On the opposite panel that receives the tie rod, the tie inserts are also assembled from the back side of this panel.

[0167] FIGS. **43A-43D** illustrate various views of hinged inside corner **2504** and hinged outside corner **2506** extrusions. Hinged outside corner **2506** includes a first member **4310** and a second member **4315**. In a 90 degree configuration, a 90 degree strap **4320** is used. The 90 degree strap **4320** may be attached to the first member **4310** and the second member **4315** using screw and nut **4322** or some other attachment means.

[0168] Hinged inside corner **2504** includes a first member **4330** and a second member **4335**. In a 90 degree configuration, a 90 degree strap **4340** is used. The 90 degree strap **4340** may be attached to the first member **4330** and the second member **4335** using screw and nut **4342** or some other attachment means.

[0169] In one implementation, instead of using screw and nut **4342**, an adaptor plate (not shown) can be permanently mounted to each extrusion using bolts, and the 90 degree strap can be attached to the adaptor plate using pull pins. In this implementation, the 90 degree strap is easier to remove when an angle that is greater or less than 90 degrees is needed.

[0170] A top view of first member **4310** is shown in FIG. **43B** as element **4345**. A side view of first member **4310** is shown in FIG. **43D** as element **4350**. Side view **4350**, illustrated in FIG. **43D** shows two removal areas. The removal areas are the spaces between the hinge members. The two removal areas accommodate the hinge members of the second member (not shown in this view), which has one removal area. A hinge (not shown) is used to couple the first member to the second member.

[0171] FIGS. **44A-44F** illustrate various connection configurations for inside corner extrusions **2504** and outside corner extrusions **2506** that are connected to formwork panels **4401**, **4403** using the standard clamp **2508a** or a bolt connection. The configuration in FIG. **44A** as element **4405** shows a 90 degree inside corner connection. The configuration in FIG. **44B** as element **4410** shows a less than 90 degree angle. The configuration in FIG. **44C** as element **4415** shows a greater than 90 degree angle. In this configuration, a hinged corner connection is capable of achieving a maximum

angle of 190 degrees.

[0172] The configuration in FIG. **44D** as element **4420** shows a 90 degree outside corner connection. The configuration in FIG. **44E** as element **4425** shows a hinged corner connection capable of achieving a maximum angle of 135 degrees. The configuration in FIG. **44F** as element **4430** shows a hinged inside corner capable of achieving a minimum angle of 55 degrees if bolts (not shown) are used instead of the standard clamp.

[0173] FIGS. **45A-45D** illustrate a stripping inside corner **2502** according to an 8" implementation. A plan view and a partial elevational view of stripping inside corner **2502** are shown in as element **4510** in FIG. **44A**. Also shown are a pour position **4515** and a stripping position **4520** for stripping inside corner **2502**. Pour/stripping position, shown in FIGS. **45C** and **45D** as views **4515**, **4520**, respectively, include panels **4501**, **4503** (including side rails **532**) and clamps **2508a**.

[0174] FIGS. **46A-46D** illustrate a stripping inside corner **4605** according to a 12" implementation. A plan view and a partial elevational view of stripping inside corner **4605** are shown in FIG. **46A** as element **4610**. Also shown are a pour position **4615** and a stripping position **4620** for stripping inside corner **4605**. Pour/stripping position views **4615**, **4620** include panels **4501**, **4503** (including side rails **532**) and clamps **2508**.

[0175] In one implementation, the stripping inside corner is adjusted from a pour position to a stripping position using either a screw mechanism (not shown) or a slotted slide plate (not shown) that draws the two sides of the inside stripping corner inward to strip and outward to re-set to the next pour position. In one implementation, the stripping inside corner can be made from aluminum and includes a slide plate configuration.

[0176] FIGS. **47A-47C** illustrate an overlapping outside corner configuration using outside corner bracket **2546**. In this implementation, the overlapping outside corner assembly **4705** includes outside corner bracket **2546** and standard panels **4701**, **4703**. The overlapping outside corner assembly **4705** can be implemented using an even increment configuration, e.g., corresponding to side **4710** or an odd increment configuration, e.g., corresponding to side **4715**. Each side **4710**, **4715** of the outside corner assembly is adjustable in 2" increments, however one side is offset from the other by one inch. Adjusting in 1" increments can be achieved by flipping the outside corner assembly over. Alternatively, this bracket can be fitted with holes every one inch to avoid having to flip the bracket over.

[0177] FIGS. **48A-48E** illustrates different views of a standard clamp **2508a**. The clamp **2508a** is shown clamping two side rails **532**. The clamp **2508a** is also shown clamping an inner rail **536**. Clamp **4805** includes a first member **4817** having a first opening **4820** configured to accommodate a first flange. Clamp **2508a** also includes a second member **4823** having a second opening **4822** configured to accommodate a second flange. A screw mechanism **4824** is used to loosen and tighten the first **4817** and second **4823** members of the clamp. In particular, the screw mechanism engages with a bottom threaded portion of the first member **4817** in order to tighten the clamp. The standard clamp **2508a** is designed to tighten with a screw mechanism and generally can be tightened without using a tool. Using this type of standard clamp **2508a** makes all accessory connections more efficient and easier for the end user. The screw mechanism is safer than other coupling mechanisms because the clamp will not loosen as easily if someone accidentally hits the clamp. In one implementation, a connector clip **4830** is permanently attached to the clamp and is configured to be coupled to other attachments used with the aluminum formwork system. The accessory clip that attaches to the connector clip of the standard clamp can serve as a standard connection for the alignment bar configuration, personal tie-off point, pipe brace attachment, and lifting bar configuration. FIG. **48D** illustrates element **4835**, which is a side view of clamp **2508a** with connector clip **4830** permanently attached. Also shown is first member **4817** and a bottom portion of second member **4823**. FIG. **48E** illustrates element **4840**, which is a front view of clamp **2508a** with the connector clip **4830** permanently attached. The connector clip **4830** has openings **4845** that are used to couple the clamp **2508a** to an accessory clip.

[0178] FIGS. **49A-49E** illustrate various views **4907, 4917, 4920** of an accessory clip **4905**. The accessory clip **4905** can be used with the standard clamp **2508a** for various other applications, e.g., pipe brace clip, alignment bar, lifting bar and tie-off point. Accessory clip **4905** includes a screw assembly **4921** and sleeve **4919**. As illustrated in FIG. **49E**, accessory clip **4905** can be attached to clamp **2508a** using screws and nuts **4915** as shown in view **4910**.

[0179] FIGS. **50A-50D** illustrate various views **5005** of a scaffold bracket or horizontal adaptor **2516a**. The scaffold bracket or horizontal adaptor **2516** may be attached to the standard clamp **2508a** using screws and nuts **5015**. The scaffold bracket or horizontal adaptor **2516a** may be used as a personal tie off point with a proper harness and lanyard. In one implementation, scaffold adaptor **2516** may be used to attach either a Ringlok scaffold bracket or a Ringlok horizontal member.

[0180] FIGS. **51A** and **51B** illustrate a Ringlok side bracket adaptor **2517**. This configuration shows how a Ringlok leg material **2517** can be attached to inner rails **536** of a panel **5131** using the standard clamp **2508a** according to one implementation.

[0181] FIGS. **52A-52D** illustrate various views of an alignment/lifting bar attachment. The alignment/lifting bar **5220** can be coupled to the standard accessory clip **5205** using a bolt assembly (not numbered). The alignment/lifting bar **5220** and standard accessory clip **5205**, may be attached a standard clamp **2508** using a screw assembly **5215**.

[0182] FIGS. **53A-53E** illustrate additional alignment/lifting bar attachments. FIGS. **53B, FIG. 53A**, and FIG. **53C** includes respective views **5306, 5307, 5309** of an optional center support attachment **5305** and FIG. **53D** and FIG. **53E** includes respective views **5310, 5312** of a lifting bracket attachment **2518a**. Also illustrated in FIGS. **53D-53E**) is a side view **2518b** of the lifting bracket **2518a**.

[0183] FIG. **54A-54C** illustrate respective views **5405, 5410, 5415** of a dry tie/hold down bracket **2528**. Opening **5420** is shaped to accommodate a tie rod or screw for dry tie and hold down applications.

[0184] FIG. **55A-55B** illustrates implementations of a dry tie application **5505** and a hold down bracket application **5530** using the bracket of FIG. **54A-54C**. Dry tie application **5505** includes a tie rod assembly (tie rod **5520** and wing nut **5510**), bracket **2528** and formwork panel **5525**. The bracket **2528** is attached to a top portion of formwork panel **5525** and the tie rod assembly **5510, 5520** is used to couple bracket **2528** to an opposing bracket attached to a top portion of an opposing panel.

[0185] Hold down bracket application **5530** includes tie rod **5540**, anchor bolt **5545**, bracket **2528** and panel **5525**. Bracket **2528** is attached to a bottom portion of formwork panel **5525** and is tied to surface **5535** using tie rod **5540** and anchor bolt **5545**.

[0186] FIG. **56** illustrates a block diagram of a method of assembling a formwork system. At block **5605**, aluminum extrusions are provided. At block **5610**, aluminum castings are provided. At block **5615**, the aluminum castings and aluminum extrusions are pressed and riveted.

[0187] The aluminum extrusions can be side rail extrusions and/or interior rail extrusions. The aluminum extrusions and the aluminum castings can be made of structural grade aluminum.

[0188] In one implementation, the formwork system can be configured such that the aluminum extrusions and aluminum castings are integrated into a shoring deck application.

[0189] In one implementation, the aluminum extrusions are adjustable and a width of the aluminum extrusions can be incrementally adjusted using different configurations.

[0190] The aluminum extrusions can be assembled to be part of a series or system of formwork panels that are coupled together using a standard clamp. The formwork panels are constructed of lightweight aluminum extrusions and fittings and are assembled with mechanical fasteners and have no welding. The standard clamp may also be used to couple attachments to the formwork panels. In one implementation, a connector clip can be attached to the standard clamp and configured to be coupled to one or more attachments for the formwork system. In one

implementation, an accessory clip can be attached to the connector clip. The accessory clip can be coupled to the one or more attachments. The attachments may include, but are not limited to, a pipe brace clip, an alignment bar, a lifting bar, a tie-off point.

[0191] In one implementation, formwork panels can be coupled via an aluminum extruded hinged corner extrusion and configured to be positioned relative to each other at a plurality of angles.

[0192] In one implementation, the aluminum extruded hinged corner extrusion can be a hinged inside corner extrusion. In one implementation, the hinged corner extrusion can be a hinged outside corner extrusion.

[0193] In one implementation, tie inserts are used with a formwork panel. Tie inserts may include self-sealing ties, tie plugs and tie inserts that install from the outside (or backside) of ganged form panel assemblies. This increases labor efficiency and reduces risk of concrete leakage through the tie port assembly. A tie nut and rod assembly can be used to couple a formwork panel to an opposing formwork panel.

[0194] The design of the present formwork system includes several key unique features that are not found in prior art systems. Below are descriptions of these aspects:

Aluminum Extrusions & Castings Vs. Welded Rolled Steel

[0195] All of the systems in use today are fabricated from rolled steel shapes, and are welded together to construct the formwork frame. While this approach may be cost effective to manufacture, it generally has its drawbacks with regard to inventory maintenance costs, as well as long term product performance. Light weight rolled steel components can wear over time, causing issues with components fitting together properly, which often creates assembly issues for contractors on the jobsite. In general, galvanized welded steel frames will eventually rust after continued exposure to chemicals present in concrete, as well as from the caustic environment on jobsites where these systems are used.

[0196] In one implementation, the formwork system of the present disclosure is constructed solely of aluminum extrusions and castings in a fashion that eliminates structural welding. This simplifies both the manufacturing, as well as the inventory maintenance aspects of a purchased inventory.

[0197] The structural capacity is generated from having the castings pressed into the extrusions. The corner castings are press fitted into the side rail extrusions and either riveted, or screwed together. The tie hole fitting, e.g., the tie extrusion, is bolted to the side rail and press fitted and bolted into the interior rail. The result of this type of assembly provides a more rigid and consistently truer frame with a higher level of durability. Since the extrusions, i.e., side rails and inner rails, tie hole fittings and castings of the formwork system are aluminum, these elements will not rust and will maintain their structural rigidity for longer periods of time, as compared to traditional welded steel types.

[0198] In one implementation, the corner casting provides added durability to help prevent damage during normal construction activities. In another implementation, the side rail extrusions are shaped to help prevent typical handling damage patterns by having specific areas thicker than those in protected areas (e.g., outer edges or walls are thicker). The thicker areas may provide protection against weather and/or damage due to construction workers or other mishaps that may occur on a construction site. There is no prior art system that is constructed in this manner.

Wall Tie Pattern and Frequency

[0199] All formwork systems require a tie system of some sort, to hold the panels on one side of a concrete wall to those on the opposite side. The liquid concrete causes pressure on the form face that push the forms apart. Form ties are used to hold the forms together to prevent movement and to allow the casting to maintain the intended shape.

[0200] Most prior art systems have a pre-defined pattern that provides limited amounts of flexibility. Additionally, prior art systems do not allow a form of two different heights to be connected on opposite sides of the wall in a fashion that allows staggering. For example, in prior art systems, the spacing of the tie holes on a shorter form are different from those on a taller height

forms. This forces builders to use the same height forms on both sides of the wall, which limits the amount of configurations that a system can achieve.

[0201] There are frequent situations that require a user to have higher forms on one side of the wall vs. the other. The tie pattern of the present system allows ties to be placed in predefined increments, e.g., 12" increments. This symmetrical tie spacing feature allows panels to be stacked and staggered in a variety of patterns from one side of the wall to the other. This exponentially increases the versatility of the product and reduces the amount of components needed.

Standard Panel Widths With an Adjustable Filler Assembly and a Variable Width Lumber Filler Assembly Vs. Prior Art Multiple Sized Panel Widths

[0202] Generally, most prior art systems offer a variety of pre-manufactured panel and filler sizes so the system will have enough dimensional flexibility to handle the wide range of field conditions. Given that most formwork applications generally use a small percentage of filler components in relation to standard panels, the formwork owner is forced to maintain a large inventory of various size filler panels in the event one particular size may be needed over another. This causes the owner to invest in seldom used assets in order to maintain dimensional flexibility.

[0203] This new system takes a very different approach, and has only two distinct panel widths. Secondly, this system has a pre-fabricated filler side rail accessory that allows users to custom build fillers to meet the size requirements for each specific application. One additional component that allows the user to have fillers of variable widths significantly reduces the amount of items to inventory. Variable fillers can be pre-assembled prior to shipment to meet the design specifications, or easily custom made in the field to handle dimensional changes from one pour to the next.

[0204] The design of the present side rail, e.g., an aluminum filler side rail, allows making custom filler sizes feasible. This component allows the user, or form provider, to easily insert standard sized wood members to create custom sized filler panel that perform in the same manner as standard panels. The filler panels attach to the primary components in the same way as the rest of the standard system, and also have the same tie hole configurations. This gives builders the same dimensional flexibility as other systems, while significantly reducing inventory components. One set of filler side rails eliminate the need for the form owner to carry large amounts of pre-fabricated and seldom used small filler panels. In addition, the filler side rails may be made or fabricated on a per order basis.

[0205] In one implementation, the filler side rail assembly will also be used for circular construction, and for walls that intersect at other than right angles. These conditions are two more examples of infrequent applications that create inventory inefficiencies as well.

[0206] This system also includes an adjustable filler assembly. This adjustable filler assembly is capable of handling a majority of straight wall filler applications. Using the adjustable filler assembly (and the lumber assembly) eliminates the necessity in the prior art of having fabricated fillers of various sizes. The adjustable filler reduces the amount of custom wood expense and time needed to fill a customer order. Using the adjustable filler assembly reduces the need for all wood inner members with a new aluminum adjustable inner member, so that the most common filler sizes can be achieved with the same frame assembly. This adjustable filler assembly is unique to the present system.

[0207] In this system, filler side rails are designed to accept lumber inner rails, however, a much smaller quantity will be needed in practice. The lumber configurations will be used primarily for odd fillers that aren't achievable using the other standard adjustable components and to make curved formwork. The lumber filler side rail uses the same side rail design as the adjustable filler, with the addition of a lumber clip, and removal of the adjustable inner rail.

Ability to Form Circular Walls Without Having a Secondary Curved Inventory

[0208] Another infrequent use of formwork is on circular concrete walls or columns. In addition to the uses for the filler side rail noted above, this component also allows the form owner to custom build curved wall forms or circular column forms by inserting radius shaped dimensional lumber,

similar to assembling variable sized fillers.

[0209] Given the advancements of computer numerical control (CNC) cutting technology, custom shaping of large quantities of wood members make this approach very practical. Through the use of CNC technology, variable radiuses similar to filler shown in FIGS. 3 and 11 can be made quickly and cheaply to order. This additional function of the aluminum filler side rail allows an owner of a formwork inventory to eliminate an entire separate inventory of prefabricated circular form panels. Given the fact that circular construction occurs on a very small percentage of concrete construction activities, and that each application has different radius specifications, not having a secondary curved form inventory eliminates a large investment that generally produces minimal returns.

Standard Clamp Connector With Attachments Vs. Multiple Clamp Types

[0210] All modern modular formwork systems use a clamping device to connect one form panel to the next. However, most, if not all, prior art systems use various configurations of clamps for specific purposes. Most have a standard clamp for the majority of connections, a second alignment clamp to maintain in line straightness for a series of panels connected end to end, and an adjustable clamp that is used when wood shims are required to make small dimensional adjustments.

[0211] The design of the clamp for the present system eliminates the need for multiple clamps because the clamp of the present system has attachment ports. The ports allow various items to be connected to the clamp, such as a simple piece of angle or wood, which can be used as an alignment bar, in straight wall applications. This aspect significantly reduces the inventory costs for clamps. Secondly, given that the present system uses side rails, e.g., aluminum filler side rails, to make variable sized filler, the need for the small wood shims of the prior art system is eliminated. Therefore, the adjustable style of clamp of the prior art is also eliminated.

[0212] The present system uses one style of clamp for connecting forms in a straight line. In contrast, prior art systems on the market today require three or more clamp varieties.

Windmill Outside Corner Connectors Vs. Modified Panels to Allow Overlapped Connections

[0213] When forming walls or columns, one item that is constantly needed is a right angle panel overlap corner. Most, if not all, prior art systems use full height special fabricated form panels, made in the same heights as the other form panels, with additional tie holes spaced to connect the overlapping panels at various increments. Formwork users who require right angle outside corners using prior art systems must carry an inventory of variable height special overlap forms to meet this requirement.

[0214] The present formwork system eliminates the special overlap form panels with the addition of the windmill outside corner connector, see FIGS. 25, 26 (item 2615), and 47. This allows two standard panels to be connected at a right angle and allows one panel to by-pass the other in a windmill fashion with the connection being at the standard tie ports. The windmill bracket allows for odd dimensional take-up based on the dimensions required for the application. The windmill outside corner bracket can be used on an outside face of two walls that intersect at a right angle, or for forming individual column structures.

[0215] Using the windmill outside corner bracket eliminates the need for an inventory of specialty panels with additional tie holes that are used to make windmill outside corner assemblies.

Variable Angled Inside and Outside Aluminum Extruded Corners With a 90 Degree Strap Vs Fabricated Steel Corners of Both 90 Degree and Hinged Types

[0216] Most prior art systems use both a fabricated steel hinged design and a separate 90 degree angle design for both inside and outside corners components. Fabricated steel is very heavy and having both a different hinged and 90 degree fabrication for both the inside and outside corners increases the amount of components required for the system.

[0217] The present formwork system utilizes an aluminum extruded hinged corner, with a standard 90 degree strap to make up variable angled corners, as well as right angles for both the inside and outside corner designs of various heights. Both the hinged and 90 degree corners configurations can be manufactured separately out of aluminum extrusions for this system. However, it is not

necessary, given the design of much lighter hinged aluminum extruded corners and the addition of a 90-degree strap, shown in FIGS. 43-44 mentioned above. Combining the use of a hinged design and right angle design into one assembly eliminates redundant inventory.

Integrated Standard Scaffolding Components Vs. Specific Components for Access

[0218] Most prior art formwork systems have components, such as scaffold brackets, that are used for workers to access the formwork during assembly, as well as to perform the placement of the concrete inside the formwork. These prior art scaffold brackets have specifically designed components that only work for that particular formwork system.

[0219] The present formwork system does not have those specially designed components. Instead, the present formwork system has simple attachment accessories that allow existing types of standard scaffolding components to be utilized. Standard scaffolding systems are readily available in the market place, and are generally made in a standard configuration that integrates with the present formwork system.

[0220] Most companies that will own this formwork, more than likely will own some sort of system scaffolding. Whether this is the case or not, this approach allows these companies to separately purchase those scaffolding components that match with the fabricated attachments on the present formwork system. The attachment accessories of the present formwork system eliminate components that would only service one construction system, and reduce the amount of equipment investment for seldom used items.

Synthetic Form Face Vs. Plywood Form Face

[0221] As mentioned above, most prior art formwork systems use a plywood based form face. The form face is the key feature that holds the liquid concrete in the shape desired. In general, a wood form face wears down frequently and has to be replaced during periodic maintenance activities. In one implementation, the formwork system described in this document may utilize a synthetic face product solely for the standard panels.

[0222] Given that the standard panels will form the bulk of the formwork inventory, using synthetic facing will significantly reduce formwork maintenance costs and virtually eliminate the need to periodically replace form faces on the standard panels.

[0223] This aspect adds to the overall robust nature of the present formwork system design and helps to reduce the overall cost to own and maintain this formwork system versus prior art systems.

[0224] In addition to the details highlighted above, the following additional improvements are discussed below:

[0225] Self-Sealing Form Tie System with Color Coded Inserts: This enhancement allows all of the ties and inserts to be assembled from the outside of the form panel. Once in place, the tie cavity is sealed so concrete will not leak into the opening. This is a significant labor savings and product maintenance improvement. There are two tie options 1) She-Bolt with Inner Rod; and 2) Yellow Insert w/PVC Sleeve & re-usable through rod. Both options use the same size threaded rod & Wing Nut washer.

[0226] Aluminum Design on Corners: All of the inside and outside standard right angle & hinged corners can be made of an aluminum extrusion with a bolt-on 90 degree strap, instead of fabricated steel. Using aluminum eliminates the need for welding and makes these parts much lighter and capable of handling various corner angles. Note: the stripping corner can still be steel, however, this stripping corner can be reduced in size from 12"×12" to 8"×8". In one implementation, an aluminum stripping corner with a center slide plate mechanism that can pull the sides of the stripping corner inward so that the complete form system can be stripped and moved as an entire unit.

[0227] Enhanced design on the adjustable fillers: A changed rail configuration is provided. The adjustable filler elements have interlocking grooves on the inner & outer overlapping splice members to limit deflection and increase capacity.

[0228] The scaffold attachments for the standard Ringlok system were enhanced. The attachments

can also be configured as a personnel tie-off point.

[0229] Removable high pressure strut: a removable high pressure strut (not shown) for the standard panels can be included. This removable high pressure strut can be made using the adjustable rail extrusions and allows for an increase in the allowable design pressure by reducing deflection on the form face. Most prior art systems upgrade their core design to handle extreme pressures, but the downside is an overdesign for day to day common uses. The approach of the present disclosure minimizes component weights and allows for adding the strut in locations where pressures become high, as opposed to the entire system. This is similar in concept to having a moveable personal tie-off point for optimal placement based on the need. This component can be used with the standard panels when the construction application dictates.

[0230] The discussion above is directed to certain specific implementations. It is to be understood that the discussion above is only for the purpose of enabling a person with ordinary skill in the art to make and use any subject matter defined now or later by the patent “claims” found in any issued patent herein.

[0231] It is specifically intended that the claimed invention not be limited to the implementations and illustrations contained herein, but include modified forms of those implementations including portions of the implementations and combinations of elements of different implementations as come within the scope of the following claims. It should be appreciated that in the development of any such actual implementation, as in any engineering or design project, numerous implementation-specific decisions may be made to achieve the developers' specific goals, such as compliance with system-related and business related constraints, which may vary from one implementation to another. Moreover, it should be appreciated that such a development effort might be complex and time consuming, but would nevertheless be a routine undertaking of design, fabrication, and manufacture for those of ordinary skill having the benefit of this disclosure. Nothing in this application is considered critical or essential to the claimed invention unless explicitly indicated as being “critical” or “essential.”

[0232] In the above detailed description, numerous specific details were set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the present disclosure. However, it will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art that the present disclosure may be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known methods, procedures, components, circuits and networks have not been described in detail so as not to unnecessarily obscure aspects of the embodiments.

[0233] It will also be understood that, although the terms first, second, etc. may be used herein to describe various elements, these elements should not be limited by these terms. These terms are only used to distinguish one element from another. For example, a first object or step could be termed a second object or step, and, similarly, a second object or step could be termed a first object or step, without departing from the scope of the invention. The first object or step, and the second object or step, are both objects or steps, respectively, but they are not to be considered the same object or step.

[0234] The terminology used in the description of the present disclosure herein is for the purpose of describing particular implementations only and is not intended to be limiting of the present disclosure. As used in the description of the present disclosure and the appended claims, the singular forms “a,” “an” and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will also be understood that the term “and/or” as used herein refers to and encompasses any and all possible combinations of one or more of the associated listed items. It will be further understood that the terms “includes,” “including,” “comprises” and/or “comprising,” when used in this specification, specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps, operations, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components and/or groups thereof.

[0235] As used herein, the term “if” may be construed to mean “when” or “upon” or “in response to determining” or “in response to detecting,” depending on the context. Similarly, the phrase “if it

is determined” or “if [a stated condition or event] is detected” may be construed to mean “upon determining” or “in response to determining” or “upon detecting [the stated condition or event]” or “in response to detecting [the stated condition or event],” depending on the context. As used herein, the terms “up” and “down”; “upper” and “lower”; “upwardly” and “downwardly”; “below” and “above”; and other similar terms indicating relative positions above or below a given point or element may be used in connection with some implementations of various technologies described herein.

[0236] While the foregoing is directed to implementations of various techniques described herein, other and further implementations may be devised without departing from the basic scope thereof, which may be determined by the claims that follow. Although the subject matter has been described in language specific to structural features and/or methodological acts, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to the specific features or acts described above. Rather, the specific features and acts described above are disclosed as example forms of implementing the claims.

[0237] Although the invention herein has been described with reference to particular embodiments, it is to be understood that these embodiments are merely illustrative of the principles and applications of the present invention. It is therefore to be understood that numerous modifications may be made to the illustrative embodiments and that other arrangements may be devised without departing from the spirit and scope of the present invention as defined by the appended claims.

Claims

1. A clamp assembly for a formwork system, comprising: a clamp, comprising: a first member having a first substantially planar side having a first surface and defining a first opening configured to accommodate a first flange; a second member having a second substantially planar side having a second surface and defining a second opening configured to accommodate a second flange; and a connector clip attached to and protruding from each of the first member and the second member, and a pipe brace having an attachment mechanism configured to releasably couple with the connector clip, wherein the connector clip configured to releasably couple with the attachment mechanism.
2. The clamp assembly of claim 1, the first flange being part of a first formwork panel and the second flange being part of a second formwork panel.
3. The clamp assembly of claim 2, the pipe brace further comprising a turnbuckle mechanism.
4. The clamp assembly of claim 3, the pipe brace being configured to provide support for the first formwork panel and the second formwork panel when the first formwork panel and the second formwork panel are coupled by the clamp.
5. The clamp assembly of claim 3, the pipe brace being configured to provide support for at least one scaffold coupled to the formwork system.
6. The clamp assembly of claim 2, the first formwork panel having a first height of 3 feet, 6 feet, or 9 feet.
7. The clamp assembly of claim 2, the second formwork panel having a second height of 3 feet, 6 feet, or 9 feet.
8. A clamp assembly for a formwork system, comprising: a clamp, comprising: a first member having a first base, a first planar portion which extends outwardly from the first base along a first axis, and a first outer portion which extends from first planar portion; a second member having a second base, a second planar portion which extends outwardly from the second base parallel to the first axis and a second outer portion which extends from and away the second planar portion; a release mechanism configured to transition the clamp assembly between a first position and a second position; a connector clip attached to both the first base and the second base, a pipe brace having an attachment mechanism, wherein the connector clip is configured to releasably couple to

the attachment mechanism; wherein the clamp assembly, when in the first position, the first planar portion and the second planar portion are urged towards each other, along a second axis, wherein the clamp assembly, when in the second position, where the first planar portion and the second planar portion are urged away from each other, along the second axis, and wherein the first axis and the second axis are perpendicular to each other.

9. The clamp assembly of claim 8, the clamp being configured to provide for the releasable coupling of a first flange of a first formwork panel and a second flange of a second formwork panel.

10. The clamp assembly of claim 9, the pipe brace further comprising a turnbuckle mechanism.

11. The clamp assembly of claim 10, the pipe brace being configured to provide support for the first formwork panel and the second formwork panel when the first formwork panel and the second formwork panel are coupled by the clamp.

12. The clamp assembly of claim 10, the pipe brace being configured to provide support for at least one scaffold coupled to the formwork system.

13. The clamp assembly of claim 9, the first formwork panel having a first height of 3 feet, 6 feet, or 9 feet.

14. The clamp assembly of claim 9, the second formwork panel having a second height of 3 feet, 6 feet, or 9 feet.
